# PRAISE FOR
# INCORRUPTIBLE
## BY ERIC RIES

"Every founder hopes their path is a straight line. It won't be. They hope they will have the right mentor to help them avoid problems. They won't. Eric Ries gives founders a playbook to help avoid the inevitable pitfalls and find your path to the business you set out to create."

**—MARK CUBAN**

"If you want to build a company that will be making the world a better place a hundred years from now, it's not enough to be a great person with good intentions—you need to consciously build incorruptible governance. Ries shows you how. Indispensable!"

**—KIM SCOTT,** bestselling author of *Radical Candor*

"*Incorruptible* destroys the myth that only sleazy founders and companies get rich. Eric Ries shows you how to build a mission-driven company that will be humane, ethical, and make piles of money for decades. A rare joy to read."

**—ROBERT I. SUTTON,** Professor Emeritus at Stanford and *New York Times* bestselling author of eight books, including *The No Asshole Rule*

"*Incorruptible* is the rare business book that is both a moral compass and a practical playbook. Ries shows us, with rigor and optimism, how to build organizations that are worthy of our trust."

**—FRANCES FREI,** UPS Foundation Professor of Service Management, Harvard Business School

"*Incorruptible* is a must-read for any founder, board member, investor, or consumer who cares about protecting entrepreneurship, innovation, and the productive power of capitalism from the dangers of short-term thinking and for anyone who recognizes the importance of trustworthy and enduring institutions for a thriving democracy."

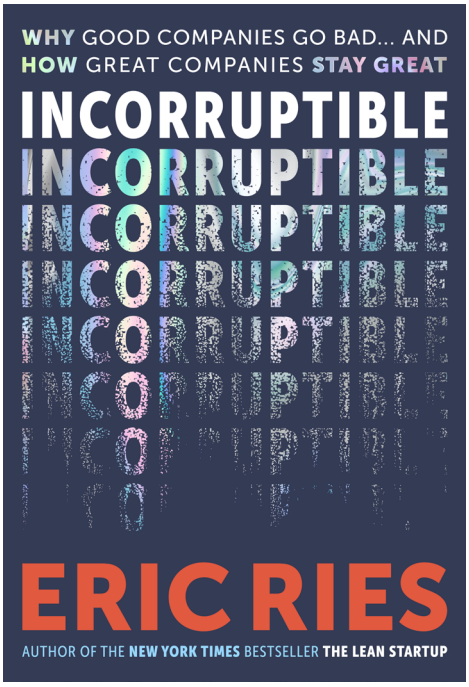
**—REID HOFFMAN,** Co-Founder of LinkedIn and bestselling author of *Superagency*

"This profound book will inform and infuriate, and then it will help you see a path forward. It should be required reading for anyone who manages (or has a manager). Gravity is real."

**—SETH GODIN,** bestselling author of twenty-one books, including *This Is Strategy*

"*Incorruptible* is the only business book I've ever read that weaves "fiduciary duty" and "human flourishing" into a single, convincing argument. Eric Ries shows why so many idealistic founders collide headfirst into a system that turns noble intentions into nasty outcomes—and then he points a way forward. By treating ownership and governance as design problems, and by drawing on vivid case studies of unfashionable but enduring enterprises, Ries offers a bracingly practical vision of how companies can stay true and still win."

**—DANIEL H. PINK,** author of *The Power of Regret and Drive*



"If you want the world to be a better place than it is, this book is a good place to start."

**—TIM O'REILLY,** Founder and CEO, O'Reilly Media

"I've read countless business books, but this is the first that had me in tears not out of sadness, but because it gave me hope. *Incorruptible* is not just a book. It's permission. It's a blueprint. And it's proof that you're not crazy for wanting to build something that's both wildly successful and deeply good, something that lasts. For any founder who truly wants to make a difference, this is a must read."

**—VLADA BORTNIK**, founder and CEO of Marco Polo

"After authoring the most important business book of the 2010s, Eric Ries has done it again. No business book became standard practice more quickly than Eric's first book. If you're a founder, a CEO planning an IPO, an investor seeking epic outcomes—stop now and read this book. It will change your life. Eric unveils the unspoken truths about how to build a legendary success...and how to keep it successful. When will it be seen as founder malpractice to not have read this book?"

**—SCOTT COOK,** cofounder, Intuit

"*Incorruptible* demonstrates the importance of mission-driven leadership and defying the status quo to build organizations that withstand the test of time. Through Eric's decades of experience building and running businesses, he articulates how companies avoid the traps of corruption and lead with values to thrive as organizations and reshape industries."

**—KEN CHENAULT**, Chairman and Managing Director, General Catalyst;
former Chairman and CEO, American Express

"Every founder eventually faces the board meeting where the mission is on the table. I've been in that room. Eric has too—and this book will help you walk out with your soul intact. *Incorruptible* is as practical as it is inspiring."

**—MATT BLUMBERG**, Author of Startup CEO and Startup Boards

"*Incorruptible* is Eric Ries at his most ambitious and original. He argues that corruption—extracting value from successful companies—results not from moral failure but from flaws in our institutions. Ries shows how organizations can be engineered to resist these flaws. This is a practical manifesto for building mission-driven companies that survive success without killing the golden goose."

**—THOMAS R. EISENMANN**, Howard H. Stevenson Professor of Business
Administration, Peter O. Crisp Faculty Chair, Harvard Business School

"As a mission-driven founder, this is the book I wish I'd had while building. Ries offers both a new vocabulary and concrete, hard-won examples for how to create real value without losing your soul at scale. He explains why mission and massive growth so often end up at odds—and, more importantly, how founders can be intentional about choosing a different path."

**—LEAH SOLIVAN**, founder, TaskRabbit

"As a first-time founder, the only thing I knew about corporate governance was what my lawyer told me. He didn't tell me much. If I'd had the knowledge in *Incorruptible* up front, it would have helped me structure my company better, and it would have helped me make better and more accountable leadership decisions as we grew."

**—KIERAN SNYDER**, founder, Textio; VP, AI Transformation at Microsoft

"We've thought of the role of business—to make money for shareholders, full stop—as immutable because for most of our lifetimes it has been that way. But a deeper view of history shows that this wasn't always the case, and Ries does a masterful job of outlining an even bolder view for our future."

—**SETH LEVINE**, Partner, Foundry VC and author, Capital Evolution and The New Builders

"This is an important book for any mission-driven leader or investor. It describes what we all feel: company after company turning their backs on their users and their founding values. It also offers a framework for avoiding that fate, packed with advice, research, and case studies of organizations that have stayed true to their mission and have thrived. It's a timely reminder that enshittification is a choice not an inevitability, that there is a better way, and that you're not alone in trying to find it."

—**ELI LUBEROFF**, founder, Desmos Studio PBC

"After decades as a venture capitalist and then founding Wealthfront, I've learned it's incredibly hard to keep a company truly mission-driven as it scales. *Incorruptible* is the most practical guide I've seen to doing exactly that. It shows how special leaders built breakthrough business models, cultures, incentives, and governance to insure their mission endured. At a time when Silicon Valley feels increasingly mercenary, this book is a refreshing reminder that idealism and performance are not trade-offs. If you're a founder, investor, or engineer who wants to change the world or build a great enterprise then this book is well worth your time."

—**ANDY RACHLEFF**, cofounder of Wealthfront and Benchmark Capital; Lecturer at Stanford Graduate School of Business

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Why Good Companies Go Bad and How Great Companies Stay Great

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